THE WOODLANDS - PARCELS R8 & R9

LAND NORTH OF A420 | SWINDON

DESIGN AND ACCESS STATEMENT & BFL12 | AUGUST 2024

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 This document has been prepared by Cooper Baillie Ltd. on behalf of Taylor Wimpey Bristol. The document sets out the specification for a Reserved Matters Application, following outline approval on the proposed development at Woodlands (R8 & R9) by a series of technical and non-technical surveys.

1.2 The Design and Access Statement structure follows the headings of the National Design Guide, published in October 2019, and complies with the regulations of the guidance in the DCLG document 'Guidance and Information Requirements and Validation' March (2010) Design and Access Statement (2006). This document sets out the context for development, constraints and opportunities, as well as the proposal's design evolution, development character, landscaping strategy, access and movement. This document sets out how the proposed development accords with the Design Code.

SITE LOCATION

1.3 The overall site at South Marston and Rowborough is located within the northern most part of the wider New Eastern Villages and comprises an area of land approximately 165 ha in size. Phase R8-R9 is situated to the north-west of the overall development, located south of the existing village of South Marston and along Old Vicarage Lane.

1.4 Figure 2.1 shows the location of the site in its wider context and Figure 1.1 shows the proposed Application boundary, 4.718 hectares / 11.658 acres.

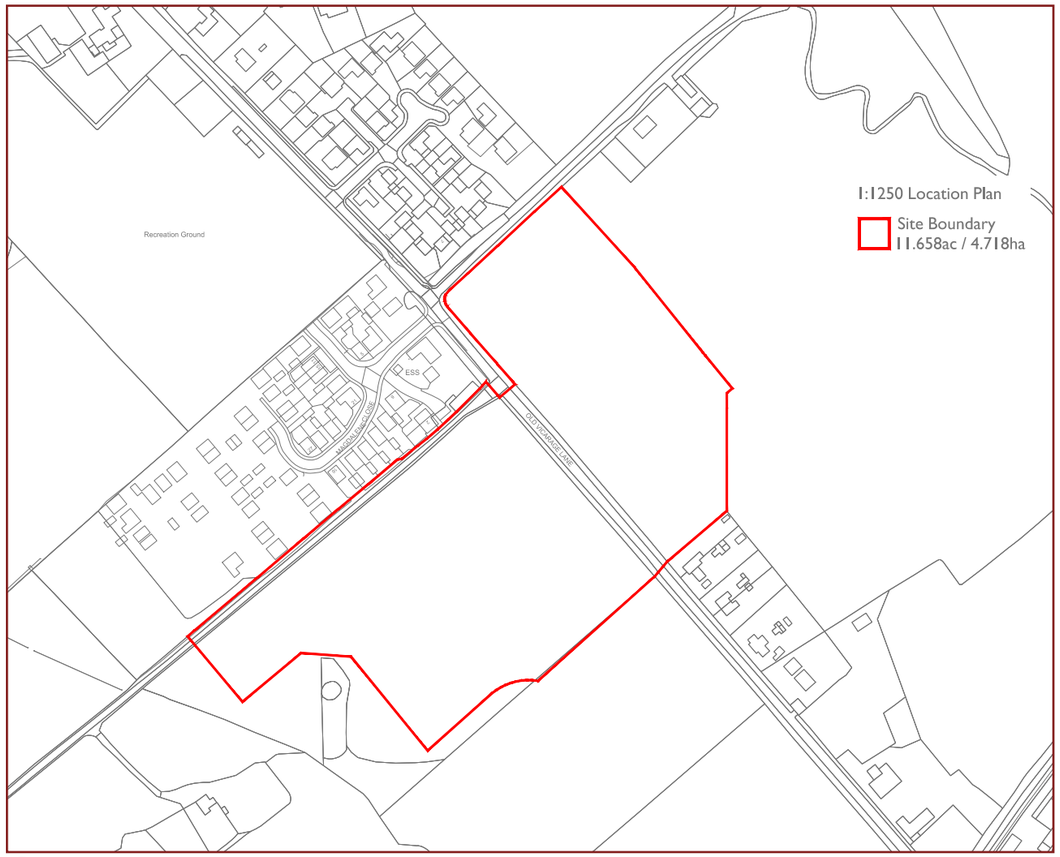


FIGURE 1.1: SITE LOCATION PLAN

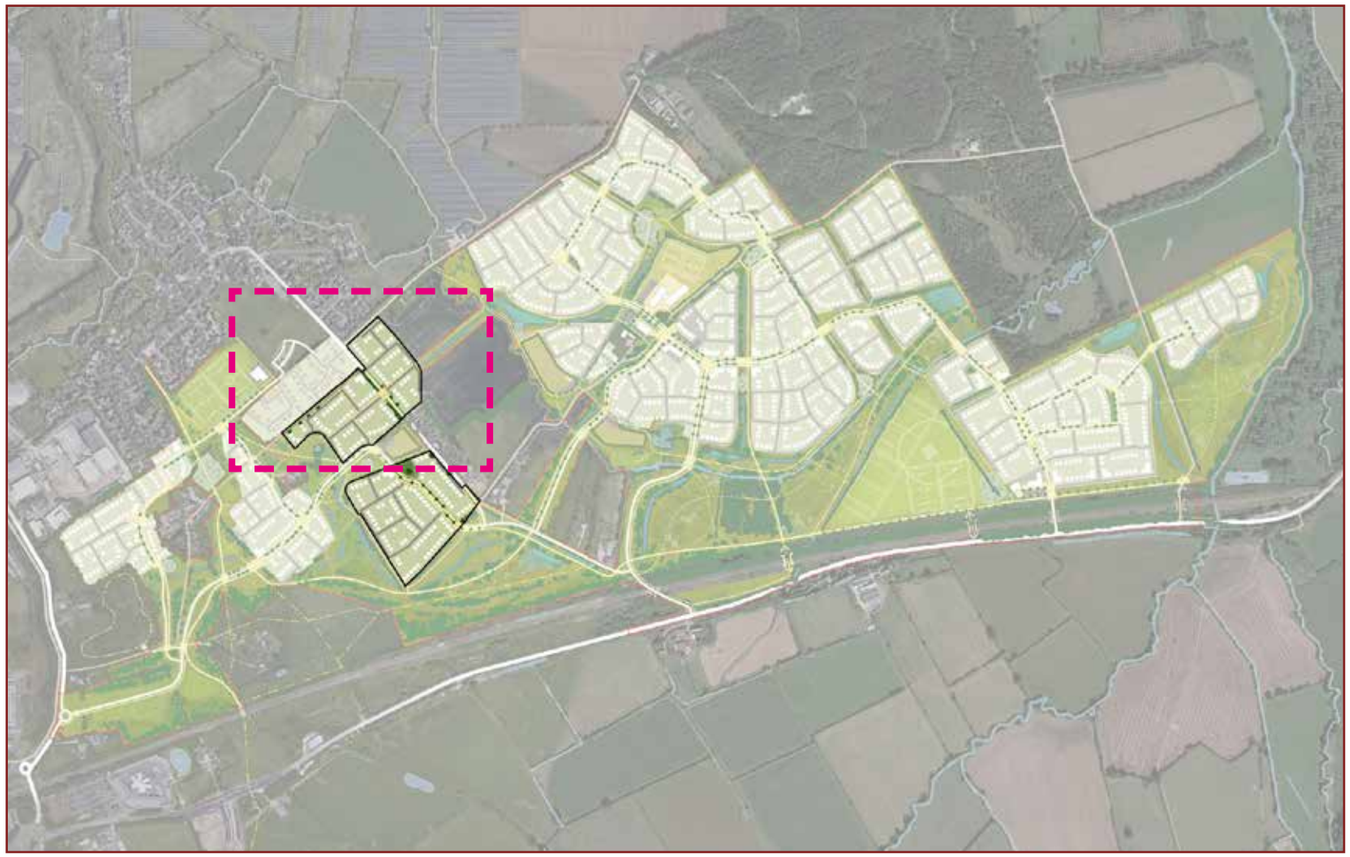


FIGURE 1.2: DESIGN CODE - CONCEPT PLAN

2. SITE CONTEXT

2.1 The Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026 allocates the site as part of the South Marston Village Expansion which itself forms part of the wider New Eastern Villages expansion. Outline planning permission was granted in August 2021 (Ref: S/OUT/13/1555) for a sustainable urban extension of up to 2,380 dwellings and other associated mixed uses. This reserved matters application is submitted pursuant to the outline planning permission and is prepared in accordance with the approved Phasing Plan (Condition 6), Strategic Design Code (Condition 8), Character Area Design Code (Condition 9) and Framework, Landscape, Ecology, Arboricultural Management Plan (Condition 10).

STRATEGIC DESIGN CODE

2.2 The Strategic Design Code was produced to inform the development of South Marston Expansion and Rowborough Village, which is part of Swindon New Eastern Villages allocation. This ensures a holistic approach, to coordination of high quality design and continuity of treatment of the public realm, throughout the delivery of the development in accordance with Policies SD3, DE1 and NC3 of the Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026.

CHARACTER AREA DESIGN CODE

2.3 The Character Area Design Code was produced in accordance with the Strategic Design Code and includes detailed guidance for the specific character areas. This involved how the character and identity of the development parcel will be established and strengthened through consideration of the public realm, green infrastructures, streets and retained/proposed landscaping.

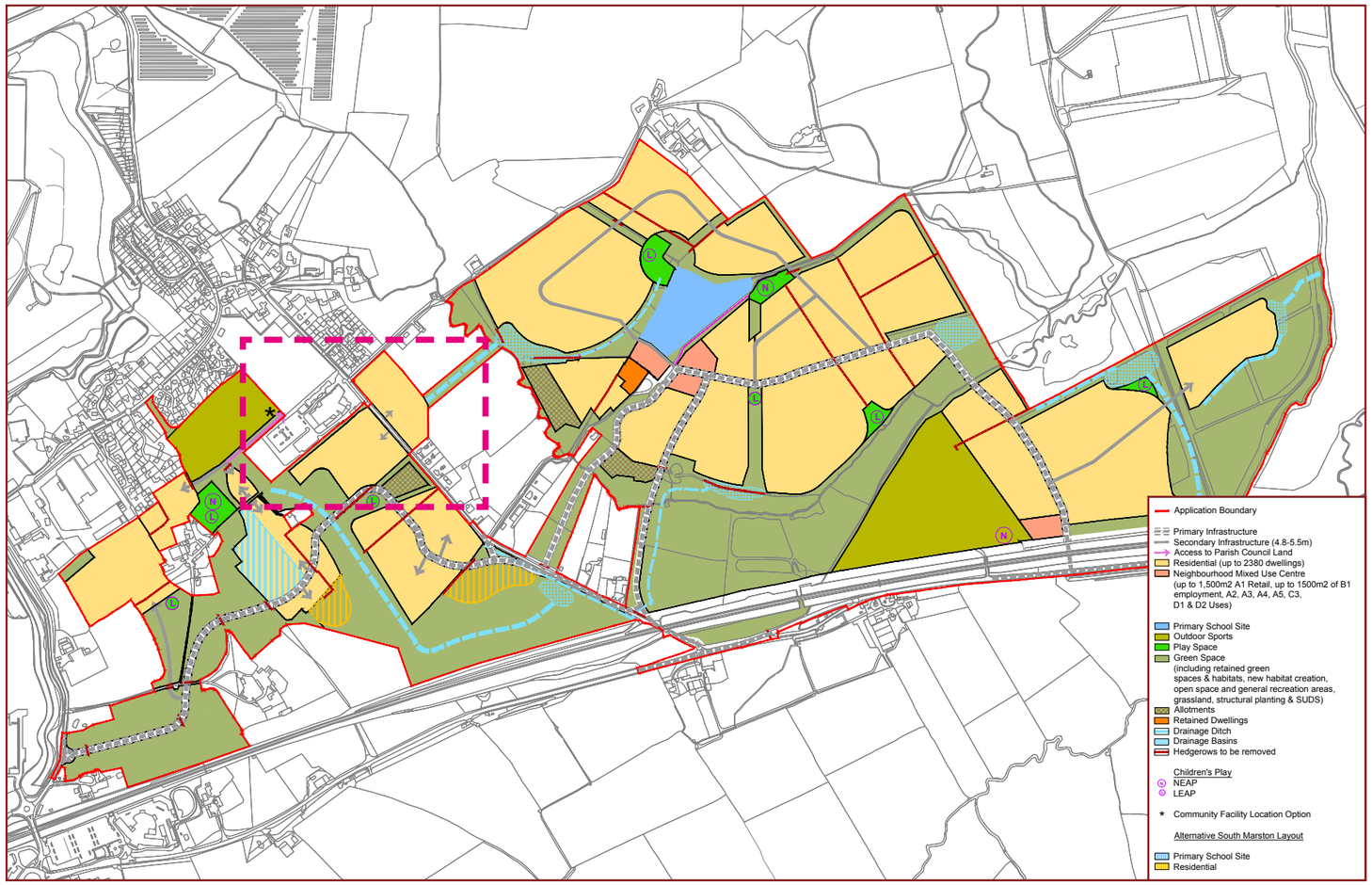


FIGURE 2.1: DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK PLAN

FIGURE 2.2: CHARACTER AREA REGULATING PLAN

CONSTRAINTS AND OPPORTUNITIES

2.4 A series of constraints and opportunities are presented on the site, which have been subject to a series of surveys and other technical and non-technical assessments as part of this Application:

- Topographical Survey;
- Noise Assessment ;
- Landscape & Visual Impact Assessment;
- Transport Assessment;
- Flood Risk Assessment;
- Ground Investigation;
- Ecological Assessment;
- Arboricultural Assessment;
- Planning Policy Appraisal;
- Archaeological Assessment;
- Heritage Assessment; and
- Air Quality Assessment.

CONSTRAINTS SUMMARY

2.5 There are a wide variety of constraints and opportunities that have influenced the design, form, and layout of the proposals. The following section seeks to summarise the key elements:

TOPOGRAPHY

2.6 The general topography within the site is relatively flat, the subtle variations and lower points are towards the south-eastern boundaries.

ACCESS

2.7 There are three proposed access points into the site, two off of Old Vicarage Lane and a third off of the new primary street running south of the village of South Marston. Opportunities for private drives have also been sought to be achieved from Old Vicarage Lane. The development also has the opportunity to tie in with sustainable transport networks both existing and future routes, associated with the wider masterplan and design code.

EXISTING VEGETATION

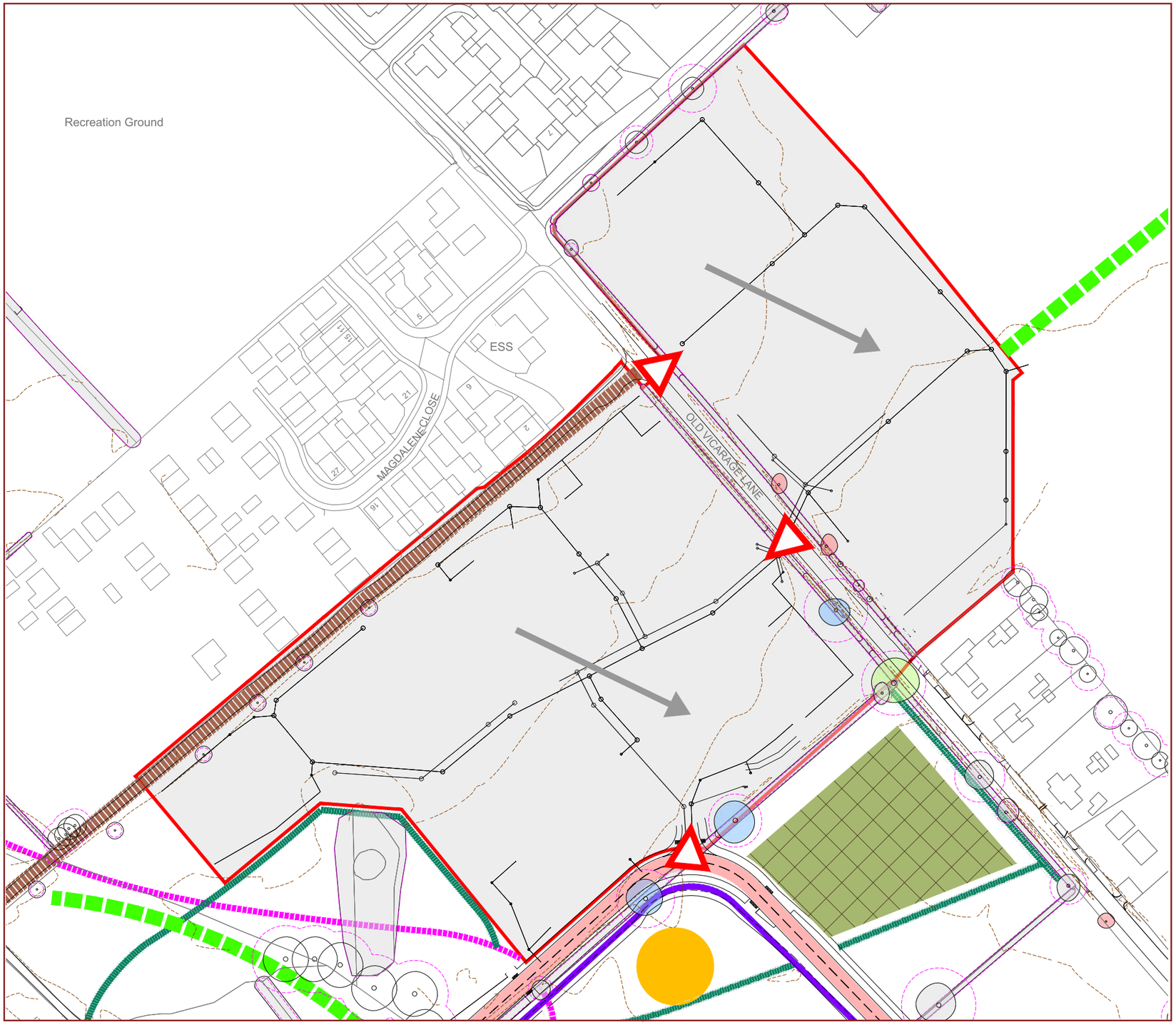
2.8 Existing trees are largely confined to the edge of the site, with a mix of specimens and categories, these have not limited the extent of the development but help provide some enclosure to the site's northern boundary and along Old Vicarage Lane.

UTILITIES

2.9 A foul sewer traverses across the site, helping to define the road and block structure, with a sub-station to be provided to facilitate the site's needs.

FLOODING

2.10 There are no flooding issues associated with this parcel of the masterplan.



Key

- Site Boundary
- Site Access
- Proposed Allotments
- Proposed Play Areas
- Proposed Infrastructure
- Proposed Secondary Footpaths
- Proposed Tertiary Footpaths
- Proposed Cycle way
- Existing Bridleway
- Existing Drainage Channel
- Direction of Fall
- Category A Tree of High Quality and Value
- Category B Tree of Moderated Quality and Value
- Category C Tree of Low Quality and Value
- Root Protection Area
- Existing Contours
- Sewer Information

FIGURE 2.3: CONSTRAINTS AND OPPORTUNITIES PLAN

3. DESIGN EVOLUTION

INITIAL LAYOUT

3.1 The initial design sought to interpret the Design Code and all of its parameters seeking to reduce the quantum of road and follow the emerging principles of the time.

FIGURE 3.1: INITIAL SKETCH LAYOUT

PRE-APPLICATION LAYOUT

CONSULTATION LAYOUT

3.2 The following plan was part of the public consultation process as well as the pre-application discussions in which elements were raised and addressed in the application layout - Figure 3.3. A principal concern was the ability to drive between the new proposed infrastructure of the wider masterplan and Old Vicarage Lane raised by the locals and Parish Council.

FIGURE 3.2: CONSULTATION LAYOUT

FIGURE 3.3: PRE-APPLICATION LAYOUT

APPLICATION LAYOUT

3.3 The layout has been revised following extensive consultation both through the pre-application process and public consultation

1 New focal open space with no vehicular traffic passing through it, creates a destination point and strong sense of character as well as reducing the opportunity for a 'rat-run' which was raised at consultation.

2 The Parish requested the cycle link runs north through the centre of the site to tie into the Bellway development to the north.

3 Through pre-application process the development was required to provide a developed edge that fronted the wider open space, which required changes to the block structure.

4 Access points for private drives have been created to make the dwellings in this location more easily accessible for future residents.

5 Desire lines have been incorporated into the masterplan to encourage and deliver ease of movement and active travel.

6 Apartment buildings have been strategically placed to terminate views from the wider masterplan and assist with legibility.

7 Parking courts have sought to be reduced where possible to provide more active frontage.

FIGURE 3.4: APPLICATION LAYOUT